



EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL OF ESWATINI
Eswatini General Certificate of Secondary Education

LITERATURE IN ENGLISH

Paper 2 (Unseen Text)

6875/02

October/November 2025

1 hour 20 minutes

Additional Materials: Answer Booklet/Paper

As listed in Instructions to Supervisors

READ THESE INSTRUCTIONS FIRST

If you have been given an Answer Booklet, follow the instructions on the front cover of the booklet.

Write your Centre number, candidate number and name on all the work you hand in.

Write in dark blue or black pen.

Do **not** use staples, paper clips, highlighters, glue or correction fluid.

Answer **either** Question **1** **or** Question **2**.

You are advised to spend about 20 minutes reading the questions and planning your answer.

At the end of the examination fasten all your work securely together.

All questions are worth equal marks.

The total mark for this paper is 20.

This document consists of **4** printed pages.

Answer either Question 1 or Question 2

EITHER

- 1 Read the following passage from a short story, about a man who returns home to discover that his wife and children have left him.

What feelings are evoked in you as you read this passage?

To help you answer the question you might like to consider the following:

- the portrayal of Khalima Zungu
- the use of language
- your feelings as you read the story.

On a warm breezy night Khalima Zungu walked from the beer hall, drunk as a fiddler. He could barely support himself on his legs, but he managed to struggle up to the door of his house. He knocked, but nobody answered. Again he knocked, and again, but the door was not opened. He then tried the knob. It was locked. Zungu kicked and heaved his shoulders against the door until sweat ran down his face. Then he remembered he had a duplicate key which the locksmith had made for him to use on such nights as this when he was locked out.

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He entered and roared out loudly, but the house was empty. Even in his state of mind, Zungu could not but notice a difference. His mind struggled to diagnose the situation. Then he decided that there was no furniture, no pictures; in fact, nothing but the bare skeleton of the house. He went to the bedroom. Here he found only his case of clothes on the floor. Besides this sad tale the house could tell no more. Zungu fell on the floor and remained there, a hopeless heap.

10

At about midnight he woke up. He wondered where he was and why he was there and not on his bed. The light was still on. Then he remembered that the scenery was not new to him. As quick as lightning Zungu sprang to his feet. He rushed out at a speed not unlike that of a scalded cat to the outside storehouse. There was a drum of petrol, left as he thought, because it was of no use to that pack of foxes.

15

My Lord – he, Khalima Zungu, formerly of the Railway Police force, would teach them a lesson. Take out all the yolk and white of an egg and mock him with the empty shell! He would reduce this shell to cinders if it meant cremating¹ himself alive in it.

20

Zungu carried the drum into the house and poured its contents over the floor and splashed some over the walls. He set the house on fire. He stood quite still as the flames reached out for one another madly and hungrily. Then he remembered, strangely enough, what he had been told at school about hell. It must be like this in hell. The spectacle itself was hell incarnated², and here he was, fitting well into it as though he was the only evil-doer (if he was) worth burning in hell. But my Lord – he must live!

25

With this thought he dashed to where he imagined the door must be, but hit against a naked wall. He turned this way and that, choking with fumes and burning. Presently he found an exit and staggered onto the verandah. Zungu felt nauseated³ and felt himself falling into someone's arms.

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When Zungu came to, he found himself in hospital. His mind was still hazy and misty. There were some people around his bed, whom he recognised as neighbours. One of them told him how he had found him, wrapped him up in some sacking and rolled him over the ground. He had known that if anybody was in that house it would most likely be Zungu himself, because he had seen his wife going away early in the day.

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He was not seriously burnt, but the shock had been severe. Zungu recovered. When he left the hospital, the problem of where to sleep confronted him. The man who had saved him offered him temporary food and a sleeping place because he had a large family. Soon he realised he would have to be a nomad, a tramp, sleeping where he could, eating what he could get.

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Glossary

1. cremating: burning a dead body, normally done as part of a funeral ceremony.
2. incarnated: to be a representation or existing in a visible form of something.
3. nauseated: a feeling of sickness with an urge to vomit.

OR

2 Read the following poem describing a particular nightfall.

Explore how the poet depicts the night in such a vivid and memorable way.

In your answer you may want to consider the following:

- the depiction of the night
- the use of language
- your feelings as you read the poem.

The Fall of Night

I've often watched the sun Sink behind the hill, And felt that awe and wonder As though the world stood still.	5
A silent coloured picture No canvas ¹ could portray, The deepening shades of evening Draws to a close another day.	10
But first the falling twilight ² , The nightly debut ³ of the stars, Which light the highway of the night Through our silent slumbering hours.	15
The moon emerges like a Queen, A Monarch on high, And beams down on her subjects From her palace in the sky.	

Glossary

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| 1. | canvas: | cloth on which pictures are painted. |
| 2. | twilight: | half-light at the end of the day. |
| 3. | debut: | first appearance. |